



PHOTOS BY **SELVAPRAKASH LAKSHMANAN**

The idea was to come back to India and settle in Manipal. That is where most of the group's activities were. When I came back from Malaysia, I decided to set up the group's head office in Bengaluru. I thought attracting talent would be easier in Bengaluru.

MEMG was set up in 2000 as the holding company to assemble talent. We followed a model like the Tatas, bringing talent together and looking at new businesses to build. Education was one vertical and healthcare another. Today, the group also has businesses in health insurance and new-age investments through Claypond Capital.

Q: What were the defining decisions that shaped the journey?

A: The Malaysia experience gave me the confidence to build further, even though I was not sure I would

be able to execute it. While I was living there, I used to spend about a week every month in Bengaluru, setting up the office and building the team.

The hospital business itself was at a fledgling stage. We always had good doctors, but the hospital was not doing well. The option was either to get out of the business or improve it. I told my father we should fix it. He gave me a free hand.

Earlier, retired people were running it. Bringing in professional managers was the turning point. Around 2004 or 2005, someone introduced me to private equity. We raised private equity in 2006 as capital was scarce.

Raising private equity helped us attract talent. The idea was to seed multiple businesses if we could get good people to execute. We kept replicating that model. In education, we eventually bought back our investors.